

Classic American Bacon (without Nitrites)

Smoky and delicious

Prep Time	Cook Time	Total Time
5 d	2 hrs	5 d 2 hrs



4.22 from 23 votes

Ingredients

- 1000 g pork belly skin removed
- 20 g salt
- 20 g dark brown sugar
- 10 g EcoCure #1
- 10 g black pepper

IF YOU WANT TO USE CURE #1 IN THIS RECIPE FOLLOW THESE DIRECTIONS

- 1000 g pork belly
- 20 g salt
- 2.5 g Insta Cure #1
- 20 g dark brown sugar
- 10 g black pepper

Instructions

Prepare the pork belly

1. If the skin is still on, carefully remove the skin without cutting into the meat/fat too much. At this time, you can also square your pork belly (make it into a rectangle by trimming the sides off) up to make it more manageable or you can leave it whole. Either way is fine.

Curing the pork belly

1. Measure the thickest part of your bacon. Record that number
2. Weigh the meat and record the weight (doing this in the metric system is much more accurate so if you can switch your scale over to grams). Once you have the weight of your pork belly enter that weight in the box (in this recipe) that reads "How much do you want to make". The ingredients will automatically calculate for you.
3. Combine all of the ingredients and rub them all over your pork belly. You will want to use 100% of your spices for this cure so don't leave anything behind.
4. After your pork belly has been rubbed with the spices place it into a zip lock bag or a vacuum seal bag. Any spices that fell off the belly, scoop them up and add it to the bag. Place it in the refrigerator.

Curing Time for the meat

1. Go to the curing calculator (link in the post above) and select the "Brining Time". Enter the thickness of your pork belly and once you get the results add an additional 20% time to it to ensure it gets cured evenly and to the center.
2. Once a day massage the pork belly and flip it over. This is optional but I find it helps the cure penetrate better

Cooking/Smoking the Pork Belly

1. I like to set my smoker to 175f (79.4c) and cook till the internal temp reaches 145f (62.7c)
2. If after 3 hours, it still isn't there increase the temp to 200f (93.3c) and continue cooking till you get to 145f (62.7c).
3. Apply whatever wood smoke you love. I like using Hickory Wood at 30% and Apple Wood at 70%, but this is just a personal preference. I am generally applying thin smoke through the entire cook. A cold smoke generator is great for regulating the smoke.

Finishing

1. Once finished, remove the bacon from the smoker and allow it to cool. Wrap in cling film and let it rest in the refrigerator overnight. this will develop the smoke flavor and allow the bacon to firm up a bit.
2. The following day, slice and enjoy!!